

TYPES OF FABRICS

The fabrics you choose to use for your project can make a world of difference to the final outcome. A single pattern can look completely different across

many quilts depending on the fabric patterns and types used and how they are put together.

Denim

Denim is a versatile choice, especially for projects that will receive a lot of use. Because of its weight it causes bulky seams and it is not suitable for hand quilting. When sewing denim by machine, use a special denim needle with a walking foot. New denim should always be pre-washed to remove excess dye.

Quilting cotton

The usual fabric of choice when making a quilt is a good-quality cotton. Quilting cotton has a higher thread count than many other cottons, which means it is both strong and wears well. Available in solid colours as well as numerous prints, there are thousands of options to choose from. It's a good idea to pre-wash quilting cotton and to buy more than your pattern requires as it can shrink by up to 5 per cent.

Organza

A sheer fabric that can be used to add an artistic touch when layered over other fabrics.



Wool

Available in a variety of weights and colours, wool is a warm, durable, natural fabric. Heavy-weight wool can be difficult to patchwork with but can make interesting appliqué. Any unfelted wools must be dry cleaned.

Velvet

The nap of velvet can make it difficult to work with and attention must be paid to the direction of the nap when cutting and joining pieces. Velvet usually requires dry cleaning. Iron carefully so as not to destroy the nap. Always sew in the direction of the nap and use a fine needle.